

DAY 5 OF 7

Understand Branching (Without the Confusion)

Branching is the concept that trips up most beginners — and it's also what lets real teams work on the same project without stepping on each other's code. Once you see a branch as just "a safe copy to experiment in," it stops being scary.



DAY 5 OF 7

A progress bar consisting of seven colored segments. The first five segments are colored (orange, purple, orange, purple, orange) and the last two are grey, indicating the current position in the 7-day challenge.

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★ WHY THIS MATTERS

Branching is the concept that trips up most beginners — and it's also what lets real teams work on the same project without stepping on each other's code. Once you see a branch as just "a safe copy to experiment in," it stops being scary.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

- Learn what a branch actually is, using a simple analogy (not a diagram full of arrows)
- Create a new branch and make a change on it
- Merge that branch back into your main branch
- See what happens (and how to recover) when a merge doesn't go cleanly

● ● ● BRANCH, THEN MERGE

```
$ git branch                # list your branches
$ git checkout -b try-an-idea # create + switch to it
$ git commit -am "Try an idea"
$ git checkout main
$ git merge try-an-idea      # bring the work back
```



Day 5 Checkpoint

Share a screenshot of your branch list showing at least two branches.

☐ MARK COMPLETE IN THE CHALLENGE FEED TO UNLOCK DAY 6